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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title:		PAGTAGAM: A NARRATIVE ON THE TRADITIONAL KNOWLEDGE AND PRACTICES ON DISASTER RISK REDUCTION OF THE LOCAL FOLKS AT TAPAZ, CAPIZ PHILIPPINES
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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check) ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields ☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences ☐ Food Research/ ☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture ☐ Extension ☐ Poster		(3) Research Center [Check the concerned center] ☒ SSITRDC Social Science and Industrial Technology Research Development Center ☐ LRDC Livestock Research Development Center ☐ FFRDC Fisheries and Food Research Development Center ☐ CSRDC Crop Science Research Development Center							
(4) Site of implementation									
		Municipality/City:	Tapaz						
		Province:	Capiz						
		Region:	VI						
(5) Classification <table> <tr> <td>Research:</td> <td>Development:</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☒ Basic</td> <td>☐ Pilot Testing</td> </tr> <tr> <td>☐ Applied</td> <td>☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization</td> </tr> </table>		Research:	Development:	☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing	☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization	(6) Mode of Implementation ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent ☐ Collaborative Research (within campus) ☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus) ☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)	
Research:	Development:								
☒ Basic	☐ Pilot Testing								
☐ Applied	☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization								
(7) Sector/Commodity		(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization							
(9) Rationale (State the research problem and significance of the project to the current needs of the country. The proposal should justify resource expenditure. A typical justification would include a brief									

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introduction, a general statement concerning the historical basis for R & D and, thrusts being addressed, utilization of the expected output and the impact information generated will have on science, the target users and the country.)

Natural disasters pose significant threats to human lives, infrastructure, and economies worldwide. Disaster risk reduction plays a critical role in mitigating these risks and building resilience within communities. The Philippines is highly vulnerable to a wide range of natural disasters due to its geographical location. The archipelagic nature of the country exposes it to typhoons, floods, landslides, and other weather-related hazards. The frequency and intensity of these events have compelled the Filipino people to develop strategies and approaches to reduce the impacts of disasters.

In the province of Capiz, particularly in the town of Tapaz, the local folks hold traditional knowledge that has been passed down through generations on their practices as to disaster risk reduction. Cuaton and Su (2020) highlighted in their study that local people utilize their local-indigenous knowledge in times of disaster. Reyes et al. (2019) argued that local folks have myriad conceptions on their environment that helps them mitigate the upcoming disasters.

Despite the growing recognition of indigenous knowledge in disaster risk reduction, there was a notable gap in the literature concerning the traditional practices in this area. While studies have explored the experiences and knowledge of various indigenous communities, there is limited research specifically focusing on the people of Tapaz, Capiz. Understanding their traditional knowledge systems and practices can contribute to a more comprehensive understanding of disaster risk reduction and help bridge the gap between traditional and contemporary approaches.

This study aims to fill this gap by investigating the traditional knowledge on disaster risk reduction of the local folks at Tapaz, Capiz. By documenting their narratives, practices, and beliefs, this study seeks to shed light on the unique insights and strategies they employ to reduce the risks associated with natural disasters. Thus, this study will be conducted to provide valuable insights for policymakers, practitioners, and local communities in the formulation and implementation of culturally appropriate and sustainable DRR measures.

(9-A) Project Description (Discuss the project strategy and plan of action of the project. It should also describe the technical procedures and other works needed to carry out the project objectives. The relationship between the project inputs and activities should be explained clearly in this section. Projects similar/related to the proposed project should be mentioned.)

The researcher will purposively select five (5) local people from Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines, to get information for the study. The researcher will use different ways to gather this information, like going into the field, watching, talking to important people, and looking at documents, pictures, and videos. Once the researcher has all the information, the researcher will write down exactly what was said or seen. Then, the researcher will study this information using a method suggested by Thomas in 2006. This method involves finding patterns and themes in the information and then figuring out what this mean. The researcher will look for ideas that keep coming up, like patterns or common themes. The researcher will group these ideas together based on what they are about. This will help readers understand the main points and make important conclusions about the traditional knowledge and practices of the local people in Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines, regarding disaster risk reduction.

(10) Objectives/Statement of the Problem (for Social Sciences) (Statement of the specific purpose to address the problem areas of the project.)

This study aims to document and record the local folks' traditional knowledge on disaster risk reduction in Tapaz, Capiz, Philippine. Specifically, it seeks answers to the following questions:

1. What are the specific traditional practices and techniques employed by the local folks at Tapaz, Capiz for disaster risk reduction?
2. In what situations within the community do the local folks apply their traditional knowledge and practices in disaster risk reduction?
3. How do the local folks effectively apply and integrate their traditional practices and knowledge in disaster risk reduction measures?

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(11) Scientific Basis/Theoretical Framework (Include concepts, theories and variables that indicate relevant relationships to be tested.

This study is anchored on the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015-2030. The Sendai Framework is a global blueprint that emphasizes disaster preparedness, resilience-building, and risk reduction. It recognizes the importance of involving all stakeholders, including the public, in facing specific disaster risk challenges. The framework provides guidance for governments and communities to enhance disaster preparedness and response capabilities, reduce risks, and prevent new risks from emerging.

Mizutori (2020) supported this framework's and posited that the main objective of Sendai Framework is to reduce the risk of human and material losses in disasters which emphasizes the role of knowledge and practices in disaster risk reduction. It acknowledges the notion that the indigenous people in local communities possess valuable traditional knowledge and experience that can contribute to improving disaster preparedness and response. In relative to this concept, Dube and Munsaka (2018) posited that the local communities have their own way of determining weather patterns and could predict imminent flooding after studying trees and clouds, and the behaviors of certain animal species. Local communities also use available local resources to put structural measures in place as part of disaster risk reduction interventions.

The study also draws support from Republic Act No. 10121, also known as the Philippine Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act of 2010. This act mandates the development and implementation of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Plan to strengthen the capacity of the national and local governments, together with partner stakeholders, to build disaster resilience and reduce disaster risks.

Furthermore, Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction of 2015-2030 helps to explore the traditional knowledge of local folks on their practices towards disaster risk reduction while the Republic Act No. 10121 serves as the legal basis that aligns these customary approaches of local folks towards disaster mitigation. This would help in understanding the narratives of local folks in Tapaz, Capiz, on their traditional knowledge and practices related to disaster risk reduction for more people-focused and effective disaster preparedness and response efforts.

(12) Review of Literature (Related researchers/activities that have been conducted. State-of –the-art of current technology / information from which the project proposal will take-off).

Disaster risk reduction (DRR) has become a global policy priority, with various countries implementing programs and initiatives to enhance community resilience. In Nepal, DRR works have been initiated, including integrating disaster risk education into school curricula, and raising awareness through disaster safety campaigns in schools and communities (Tuladhar et al., 2015). However, the effectiveness of public participation in DRR initiatives has been questioned in certain areas, such as Katlehong township in South Africa, where stakeholders show reluctance to engage (Nkombi and Wentink, 2015).

In contrast, traditional top-down approaches in disaster management often neglect the capacities of local communities to reduce disaster risks and impede community empowerment. Shifting towards decentralized, community empowerment systems can better address the Sendai Framework's four Priority Areas in disaster risk reduction (Imperiale and Vanclay, 2020).

Moreover, the knowledge in the production and implementation processes are crucial for effective disaster risk reduction. While data and information are being addressed, efforts to improve knowledge management structures and integrate knowledge systems at different levels are still limited. Enhancing the understanding of the connections between disaster risk, knowledge, and learning can improve the coherence and coordination of knowledge among various actors and arenas (Weichselgartner and Pigeon, 2015).

In a study conducted by Munsaka and Dube (2018), local communities in Zimbabwe possessed a deep understanding of weather patterns and could effectively predict imminent flooding by observing trees, clouds, and the behavior of certain animal species. These communities utilized available local resources to implement structural measures as part of their disaster risk reduction interventions.

The locals possess indigenous knowledge which takes various forms, ranging from intangible cultural values and stories to tangible objects such as stones or musical instruments. These forms of

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knowledge in risk management provide tools for communities to deal with the danger of tsunamis and earthquakes and reduce their negative impacts.

The Philippines faces significant vulnerability to natural disasters due to its location along the typhoon belt and the Pacific ring of fire. Disaster risk reduction (DRR) is crucial to reduce the impact of these hazards and manage disasters effectively. Soriano (2019) stresses the relevance of disaster-related knowledge in the community, encompassing disaster preparedness, readiness, adaptation, awareness, and risk perception.

Furthermore, the Philippines has experienced devastating disasters in recent years, resulting in casualties, population displacements, and economic losses. Guha-Sapir et al. (2011) report on the various types of disasters, such as floods, landslides, and typhoons, that have affected millions of lives and caused significant damage and over the past years the frequency and severity of disasters had led to the increase importance of effective disaster risk reduction strategies.

Disaster Risk Managers in poor provinces of the Philippines express concerns about their preparedness for typhoon impacts. Their experiences of past disasters influence their risk perception and preparedness levels. Additionally, financial aid allocation may not align proportionately with damages suffered, with a focus on response rather than preparedness and resilience. Building capacity in local governments tailored to their specific vulnerabilities is necessary for more effective disaster preparedness (Domingo et al., 2018).

The integration of indigenous knowledge in disaster risk reduction has been a topic of interest in the social sciences. Scholars advocate for participatory processes and integrative frameworks that incorporate traditional knowledge with modern scientific approaches. The study by Reyes et al. (2019) emphasizes the importance of indigenous knowledge in reducing disaster risk in specific communities. Indigenous knowledge on ocean waves, winds, animal behaviors, and other natural indicators contributes significantly to disaster preparedness in San Miguel Island, Camotes Island, and Alabat Island.

Developing countries like the Philippines face compounding risks from environmental degradation, urbanization, high population density, and weak institutional capacities. Integrating traditional knowledge into national policies is critical for mitigating disaster impacts. Brucal et al. (2020) emphasize the need for local implementation mechanisms to ground national policies among vulnerable communities.

The study conducted by Quilo et al. (2015) on the indigenous knowledge and practices among the Subanen community in the Zamboanga Peninsula, Southern Philippines shown that the local community have their own practices in mitigating the risk of disasters through observation of the waves of the sea, the movements of the animals and the environment.

Similarly, the strong relationships that exist among humans, non-human elements (nature and animals), and the metaphysical realm in the Subanen communities represents their deep understanding of disasters. The Subanen's rich belief in animism is intricately connected to their disaster awareness. They rely on their knowledge of animal warnings and signs in nature to anticipate and interpret disasters. However, Subanen's interpretation of disasters also goes beyond their animistic cosmologies. They also recognize anthropogenic activities, such as illegal logging and forest denudation, as contributing factors to disasters.

While the Subanen acknowledge the power of nature and the metaphysical in mitigating the risk of disasters, they do not solely rely on nature's whims. Instead, they actively engage in rituals. These rituals serve as a means of connecting their practices with the non-human elements and the metaphysical, reinforcing their resilience and ability to respond to disasters effectively.

The doctoral dissertation by Balay-As (2019) on the Kankanaey people shown diverse perspectives on disasters. The Kankanaey people recognize the adverse effects of development aggression, particularly mining, as forms of disaster that affect their everyday lives. The study revealed that local folks possessed a deep understanding of their environment, gained through generations of experience and observation. They relied on traditional indicators such as weather patterns, animal behavior, and plant characteristics to predict and mitigate the risks associated with disasters.

Indigenous communities' embeddedness in their environments has led to the development of local and indigenous knowledge (LIK) for disaster preparedness and response. LIK encompasses various strategies, and efforts are being made to integrate it with scientific knowledge to enhance DRR (Hadlos, 2022).

Ravago (2020) aims to develop a Localized Disaster Risk Management Index (DRMI) for local

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government units (LGUs) in the Philippines. The study uses primary survey data from LGU officials to measure their disaster risk management and coping activities. The results indicate a negative correlation between the Localized DRMI and recovery, highlighting the challenges faced by LGUs in areas frequently experiencing severe disasters due to hydrometeorological hazards. The Localized DRMI serves as an indicator to help LGUs identify areas of need and improve preparedness for disasters.

Salvacion (2023) measures village-level drought risk in Marinduque, Philippines, using Principal Component Analysis (PCA) and fuzzy logic. The study identifies villages with high drought risk in specific regions influenced by topography and climate. Vulnerable areas are characterized by high mountainous regions and low rainfall. Social vulnerability is also observed in areas with a large population of vulnerable groups engaged in agriculture.

Cuaton and Su (2020) examine how the Mamanwa indigenous peoples in Basey, Samar utilizes local-indigenous knowledge during disasters, such as Typhoon Haiyan. The study highlights their use of knowledge in emergency evacuation, food and livelihood security strategies, and weather forecasts. Despite the lack of integration in disaster risk reduction policies, local DRR practitioners find ways to incorporate local-indigenous knowledge in their programs and activities, with elders ensuring the preservation and transmission of knowledge to the younger generation.

Valenzuela (2020) investigates how disaster risk is perceived in low-risk coastal areas like Puerto Princesa City, Palawan. While the national data reflects local conditions, community members lack a clear understanding of the risks, particularly coastal hazards. The study emphasizes the need to raise awareness and correctly explain potential hazards even in communities with relatively lower disaster risk to improve disaster risk governance.

(13) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods, duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Methodology

Qualitative research will be chosen as it allows for a comprehensive exploration of subjective experiences, meanings, and social contexts. By utilizing methods such as interviews, observations, and document analysis, the researcher will be able to gather detailed and extensive data that could provide deep insights into the community's knowledge and practices related to disaster risk reduction. Specifically, narrative inquiry will be utilized in this study to delve into the personal stories, anecdotes, and narratives of the local folks. By collecting and analyzing these narratives, the researcher aims to gain a deeper understanding of the community's experiences, perspectives, and cultural contexts. This approach allows for the exploration of the community's lived experiences, cultural heritage, and the meanings embedded in their narratives. Through the analysis of the collected narratives, the researcher aims to identify themes, patterns, and unique insights that would contribute to a more comprehensive understanding of traditional knowledge and practices on disaster risk reduction of the local folks at Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. By centering the study on the narratives of the community members, the research design aims to give voice to their experiences and shed light on their indigenous practices in mitigating and adapting to natural hazards.

Participants

The respondents of this study will be the purposively selected five key informants from the community at Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. The key informants were chosen based on the following criteria: (1) elders of the community who have a deep understanding on the traditional practices on mitigating disasters, (2) traditional leaders of the community with experiences on the practices in disaster risk reduction, and (3) members of the community who are actively engaged in improving disaster resiliency.

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Locale of Study

The locale of the study is Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. Tapaz is a municipality located in the province of Capiz, situated in the Western Visayas region of the Philippines. It is known for its diverse natural environment, including mountains, rivers, and agricultural lands. Tapaz is predominantly inhabited by the Panay Bukidnon indigenous community, also known as the Indigenous Peoples of Panay Bukidnon. The Panay Bukidnon people have a rich cultural heritage and strong connection to their ancestral lands. They have developed traditional knowledge and practices over generations, particularly in relation to disaster risk reduction (PhilAtlas, 2024).

The choice of Tapaz as the locale for this study is significant because it allows for an in-depth exploration of the traditional knowledge on disaster risk reduction among the local folks, specifically within the context of the Panay Bukidnon indigenous community.

Tapaz, Capiz provides an ideal setting for investigating the traditional knowledge and narratives of the local folks in managing and mitigating the risks associated with natural hazards prevalent in the region. The geographical and cultural characteristics of the locale contribute to the distinctive context in which the study is conducted, offering valuable insights into the indigenous community's response to disaster risks.

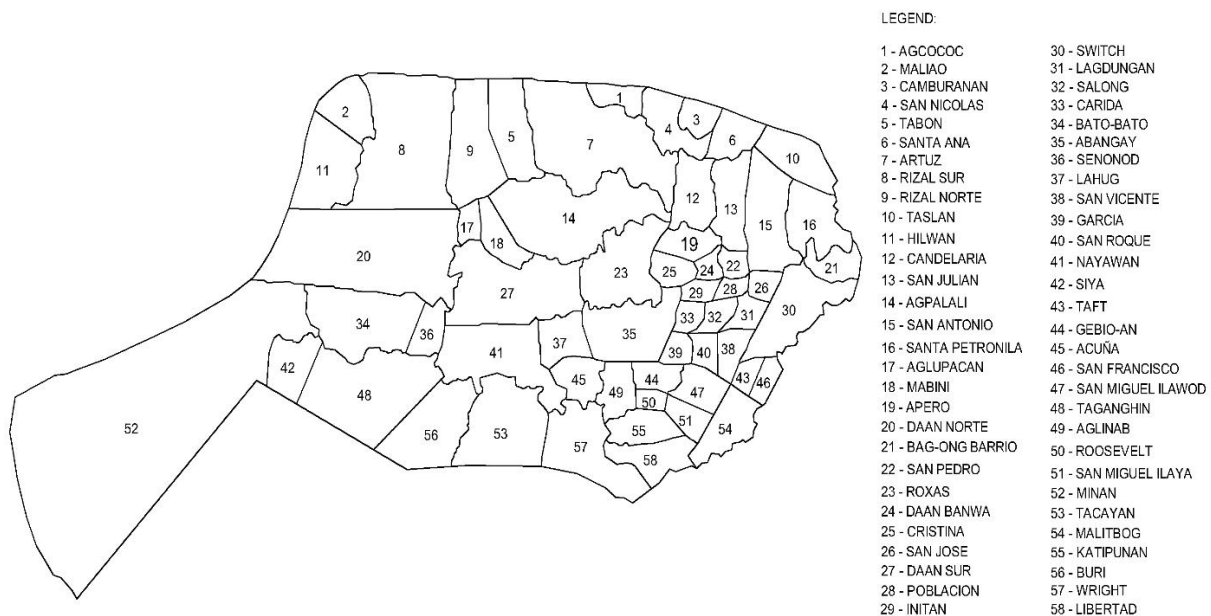


Figure 1. Map of Tapaz (Berondo, 2023)

(14) Major Activities/Work plan (Enumerate in chronological order the task to be undertaken. Use Gantt chart. Below is an example. This can be modified based on your desired Work plan.)

Research Objectives	Year 1											
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sept	Oct	Nov	Dec
1. Preparation and presentation of research proposal												

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A4 size bond paper	10	reams	350	3,500
Black and colored inks	4	bottles	300	1,200
Tape measure	5	pcs	50	250
Recording Notebook	1	pc	80	80
Ballpen	10	pc	30	300
SUBTOTAL				32,250.00
Personnel Services (For studies needed the Research Assistant, informant/s, guide)				
Research Assistant	Days	90	500	45,000.00
Travel Allowance	Days	90	150	13,500
SUBTOTAL				58,500.00
TOTAL EXPENSES				90,750.00

(19) Literature Cited (include only those references published in reputable journals, and at least that from CAPSU Research Journal, <http://researchjournal.capsu.edu.ph/>)

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(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

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